

Pranav Gillella

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Champaign, IL

Bachelor of Science, Finance, Gies College of Business

Expected Graduation: May 2030

- Minor in Computer Science, Grainger College of Engineering
- Planned coursework: CS 225 Data Structures, Probability and Statistics, Financial Accounting, Business Analytics

Hebron High School

Carrollton, TX

High School Diploma

Graduation: May 2026

- GPA: 3.95/4.00 unweighted, 5.03 weighted; ACT: 34
- National Merit Commended Scholar; AP Scholar with Distinction; scores of 5 in Calculus AB, Calculus BC, and Computer Science A

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quant Labs LLC

Carrollton, TX

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Jun 2026 - Present

- Founded and operate a two-product software company spanning consumer scheduling (EarlyDMV.com) and property tax appeals (Protestly), generating \$9K in revenue over 3 months
- Serve as sole developer, designer, and operator across product, infrastructure, payments, legal documentation, and go-to-market
- Drafted Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, and Refund Policy for both products without outside counsel
- Manage all customer acquisition, billing, and support for a combined client base across both product lines

EarlyDMV.com, Quant Labs LLC

Carrollton, TX

Founder & Full-Stack Developer

Jun 2026 - Present

- Built and shipped a paid Texas DPS appointment rebooking service end to end, cutting appointment waits by 2 weeks on average across 10 customers in the first 2 months
- Developed the full stack solo in Django and HTMX with Stripe checkout, Apple Pay support, and automated transactional email
- Self-hosted the production application on personal Linux hardware exposed through Cloudflare Tunnel, running at \$0 cloud hosting cost
- Configured CI/CD with GitHub Actions self-hosted runners and resolved live production failures including nginx 405 errors blocking Stripe webhooks and Apple Pay domain verification
- Rearchitected and rebranded the product from an earlier SlotFinder build spanning separate UI, API, and scheduler repositories
- Shipped an animated HTML product demo on GitHub Pages and ran go-to-market through TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, and print flyer campaigns

Protestly, Quant Labs LLC

Carrollton, TX

Founder & Property Tax Consultant

Jun 2026 - Present

- Represented 30 Denton County homeowners in online Appraisal Review Board video hearings, cutting client tax bills by \$32K and generating \$8K on a 25% contingency fee
- Retained all 30 clients for a second protest cycle, a 100% commitment rate after the first full season
- Engineered 4 Claude AI agent skills automating DCAD data pulls, 6-page evidence packet generation, eFile portal submission, counter-offer evaluation, and ARB hearing preparation
- Designed a client portal with a 3-step intake wizard, color-coded status dashboard, and admin panel backed by a DCAD ingest pipeline, cap-aware savings math, and automated invoicing

- Filed protests supported by comparable sales analysis, equity analysis, and market trend data under Texas Tax Code sections 41.41, 41.43, and 23.01
- Operate on a no-win, no-fee contingency model requiring zero upfront cost from homeowners
- Pursuing a Texas real estate license and TDLR property tax consultant license while expanding the pipeline to Collin, Tarrant, and Dallas appraisal districts

Independent Quantitative Research

Carrollton, TX

Quantitative Developer

Mar 2026 - Present

- Built a moving average crossover backtesting engine in Python implementing signal generation, position sizing, transaction cost modeling, and full equity curve simulation
- Computed performance metrics from scratch including Sharpe ratio, maximum drawdown, and win rate rather than relying on external backtesting libraries
- Ran the strategy on a \$100K paper portfolio through the Alpaca Markets API with historical OHLCV data pulls
- Applied walk-forward optimization across parameterized short and long SMA windows to remove look-ahead bias
- Extending the engine to a Fama-French factor model while working through Joshi's quantitative finance interview guide

Intellichoice Tutoring

Carrollton, TX

Co-President

Aug 2025 - May 2026

- Recruited 15 peer tutors through social media outreach and club partnerships to serve 200 students
- Directed 3-hour weekly Saturday sessions at a local elementary school spanning Pre-Algebra through Calculus and Physics
- Oversaw scheduling and logistics for a community math and science program targeting underserved students

Self-Employed

Carrollton, TX

Private Tutor

Sep 2023 - May 2026

- Tutored 5 AP Calculus AB and BC students nationwide for 2 hours weekly across three academic years
- Guided all 5 students to scores of 4 or higher on the AP exam and course averages above 85%

Snow City Cafe

Carrollton, TX

Cafe Associate

[Month] 2025 - [Month] 2026

- Handled customer service, food preparation, and cash handling in a high-volume cafe environment
- Maintained order accuracy and service speed during peak hours alongside a rotating shift team

PROJECTS

MA Crossover Backtesting Engine

Python, Alpaca Markets API

github.com/pranavg237/ma-crossover-backtest

2026

- Parameterized short and long window SMA crossover strategy with equity curve simulation and transaction cost modeling
- Implemented walk-forward optimization to avoid look-ahead bias, with extension to a Fama-French factor model in progress

Property Tax Protest Automation Pipeline

Python, Claude API, Playwright

Multi-agent document and filing system

2026

- Architected a multi-agent Claude skill system scraping DCAD through Chrome MCP and building professional PDF evidence packets
- Automated eFile portal submission end to end with Playwright, removing manual filing from the protest workflow
- Designed the data model, storage layer, payments, and email infrastructure to support 2,000+ client scale

Self-Hosted Web Infrastructure

Linux, nginx, Cloudflare Tunnel

Production hosting for two live businesses

2026

- Run both production business sites off self-managed local Linux hardware behind Cloudflare Tunnel at \$0 hosting cost
- Configured nginx reverse proxying, TLS termination, launchd service supervision, and GitHub Actions self-hosted runners for deploys

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Financial Engineering Club, University of Illinois
Member

Champaign, IL
Aug 2026 - Present

- Attend weekly sessions on derivatives pricing, market microstructure, and quantitative trading strategy
- Collaborate with peers on Python-based research and trading projects outside of coursework

Gies Ambassadors, Gies College of Business
Ambassador

Champaign, IL
Aug 2026 - Present

- Represent Gies to prospective and admitted students and families through campus tours and student panels
- Support college recruitment and branding through video features, photo shoots, and admitted student events

Hebron High School Band
Squad Leader

Carrollton, TX
Aug 2022 - May 2026

- Led a squad within a 200+ member ensemble, serving as liaison between directors and members
- Earned TMEA All-State Band membership in 2026 and All-Area clarinet honors across three consecutive years
- Earned consecutive Superior ratings at UIL Solo and Ensemble competition
- Placed 3rd at BOA Grand Nationals in 2023, 1st at UIL State in 2024, and 1st at BOA Super Regionals in 2025 with the ensemble

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Python (advanced; numpy, pandas, matplotlib), Java (intermediate)

Frameworks: Django, HTMX, React, Next.js, Playwright

Infrastructure: Linux (self-hosted), nginx, Cloudflare Tunnel, launchd, GitHub Actions (self-hosted runners), Git/GitHub

Tools & APIs: Alpaca Markets API, Claude API, Chrome MCP, Stripe (including Apple Pay)

Finance: Equity valuation, options pricing, strategy backtesting, factor models (Fama-French), Texas property tax law (Tax Code 41.41, 41.43, 23.01)

Interests: Quantitative trading, clarinet performance, strength training, self-hosted infrastructure

AWARDS & HONORS

TMEA All-State Band, Texas Music Educators Association
All-Area Clarinet, TMEA Region
National Merit Commended Scholar
AP Scholar with Distinction
National Finalist, InvestWrite
Grand Champion, Stock Market Game

Feb 2026
2024 - 2026
Sep 2025
Jul 2025
May 2023
May 2023